Thank you, Ruthie, and thank you—albeit belatedly—to Meki.
May his memory be a blessing.

Moshe Levin ("Kokla") (October 19, 2009)

Fifteen years have passed since Kokla left us. The eulogy at the funeral was full of emotion. It expressed the helpless feeling that the happier the time, the sooner it passes.

Kokla left us when he was at the peak of his life in terms of his own self-realization. My words today will not be a eulogy but will rather express thoughts and meditations, more logic and less sentiment. Fifteen years have gone by, we have all aged, and thoughts arise in our minds about the concept of time—for example, the notion that when you are young the days are short and the years are long, and when you are old the days are long and the years are short—just as it seems that it was only yesterday that we lost Kokla.

The concept of friendship also transforms over the years. It goes from a sense of loss the moment that a friend is taken from you, because true friendship is tested most of all when you are in distress and in need of help and support, to a feeling of profound longing, for it is good for a person to have one friend whom he trusts and to whom he can reveal everything that is in his heart. And when that friend is gone, you have no one to open your heart to. Friendships are more valuable than blood ties. An old proverb says, "Who will you love more—your brother or your friend? I will not love my brother until he is my friend."

I thought a lot about what I would say this evening that would be fitting for this event and for those in attendance, some of whom knew Kokla and some who did not. In the end I decided that I should say a few things about leadership. Not necessarily everything I am going to say was embodied in Kokla's personality, but a considerable part certainly was.

If I had to define the attributes required of a leader, I would mention the following three:

1. The leader should have a *charismatic* personality. Charisma is an innate quality of leadership and personal charm, which fosters a great degree